

DiceArt Converter

Transforming Images into Physical Dice Mosaics

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Final Project - Visualization & Data Processing



Problem / Motivation

- **Motivation:** Converting digital images into physical mosaics using standard 6-sided board game dice.
- **Problem:** Traditional pixelation ignores local structure (edges/lines), leading to a loss of detail in faces and textures.
- **Goal:** An easy to use GUI tool that offers intuitive image navigation (zoom, pan, crop), customization settings and allows the user to exports both a visual dice image aswell as blueprints to assist real world recreation.

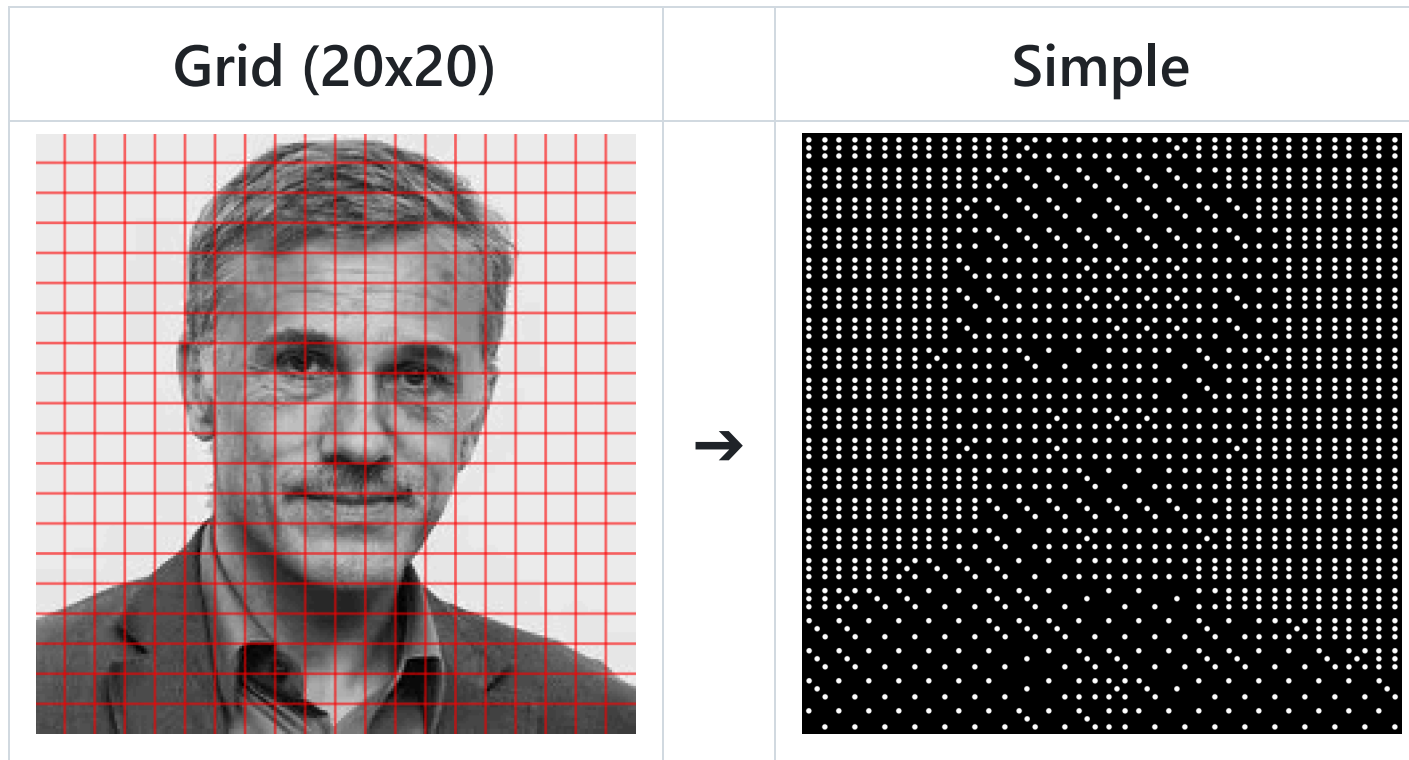
Core Concept

- **Rasterization:**
 - The source image is divided into equal-sized squares based on user input (Width/Height in Dice).
 - Each of these squares corresponds to exactly one physical die.
- **Grayscale Calculation:**
 - The average grayscale value of all pixels contained within a square is calculated.
 - The result is a single brightness value between 0 (Black) and 255 (White).
- **Dice Approximation:**
 - The brightness spectrum is mapped to 6 dice values.
 - The algorithm selects the die face (pip count) that best matches the square's mean brightness.

🎲 Algorithm 1: Simple Mode (Brightness Mapping)

The baseline method, focusing purely on luminance.

- **Function:** Maps the average brightness of a square directly to a dice value (1–6).
Dice are NOT rotationally optimized.





Algorithm 2: Gradient Mode (Rotational Optimization)

Treating dice as geometric shapes to approximate lines and edges.

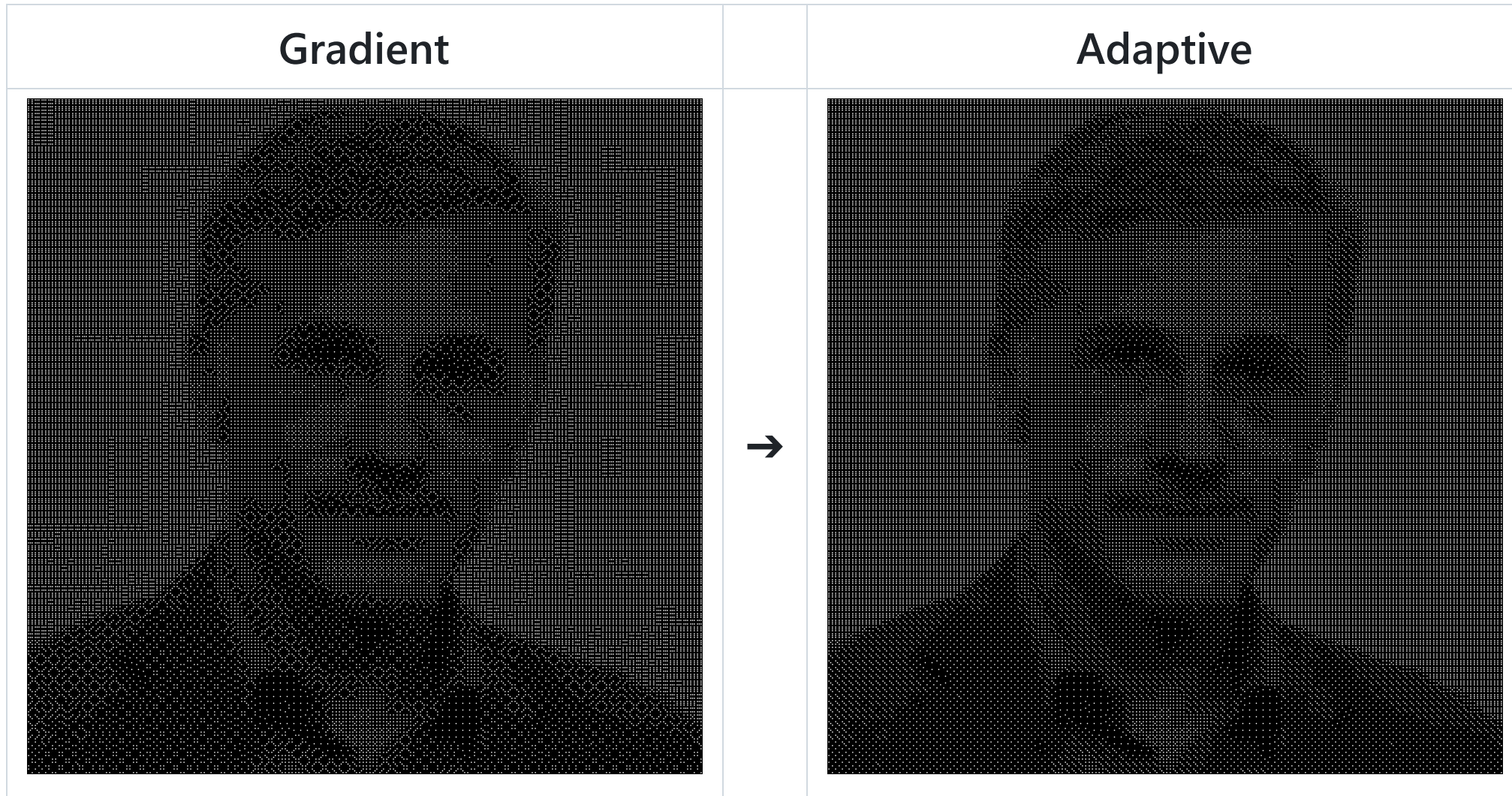
- **The Goal:** Detect the orientation of features (like eyes, jawline or hair) and rotate the die to best fit that line.
- **Chunking:** Both grid square area and dice reference picture are discretised using a specified chunk resolution (e.g.: Chunk Size 32x32).
- **MSE Calculation:** The algorithm compares each chunk against **4 pre-rotated variants** (0° , 90° , 180° , 270°) of the target die.
- **Gradient Detection:**
 - Uses **Mean Squared Error (MSE)** to find the mathematical "best fit"
 - By comparing pixel-by-pixel, the code identifies which rotation aligns its dots best with the identified feature of the image.

Challenges & Solutions

- **Visual Noise:** Initially, slight brightness noise in smooth areas caused dice to rotate randomly, creating a chaotic "nervous" and unnatural looking dice art picture.
 - **Solution:** Implementing the **Adaptive Algorithm** with variance thresholding to ignore insignificant gradients.

Example on next slide →

Visual Noise Example

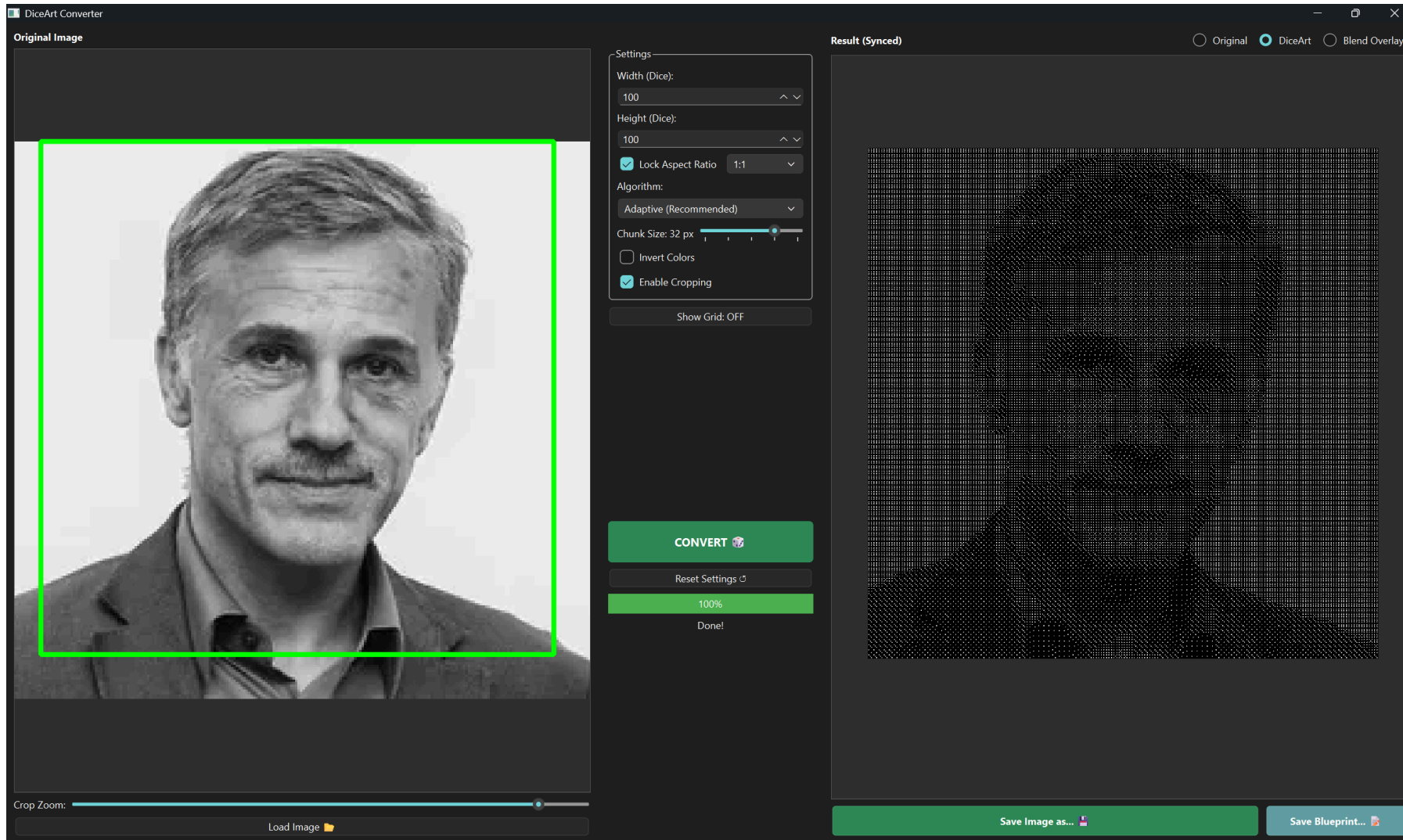


Algorithm 3: Adaptive Mode (Recommended)

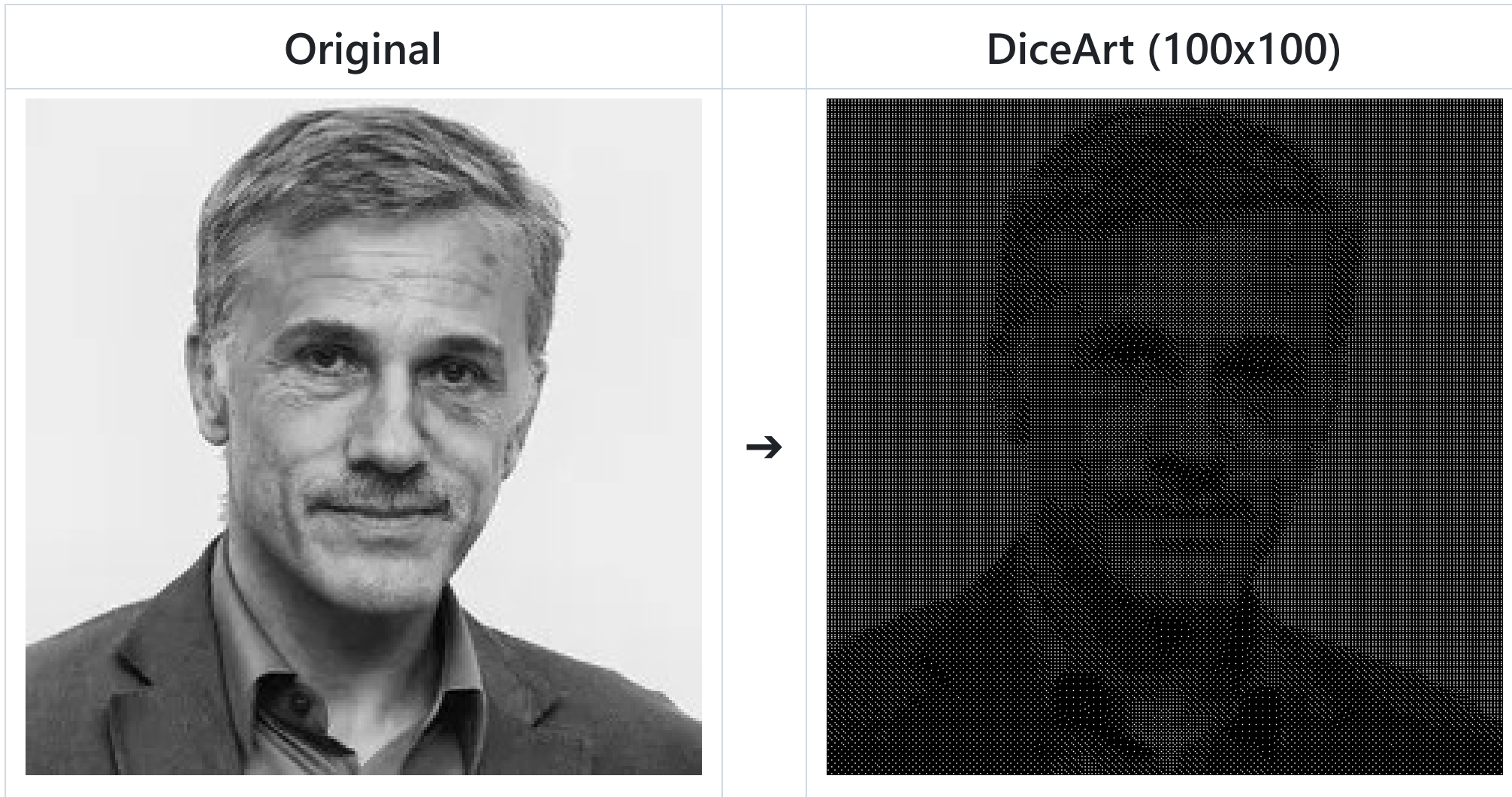
A sophisticated approach to prevent "visual noise" in homogenous areas.

- **Statistical Measure:** The code calculates the **Standard Deviation** (σ) of the chunk's pixels.
- **The Decision Logic:**
 - **Low Variance:** The area is "smooth" (sky, skin). The code stays with **Simple Mode** (North orientation) to keep the area homogeneous.
 - **High Variance:** The area contains an edge. **Rotational Optimization** is triggered.
- **Significance Check:** A rotation is only used if it improves the MSE by **>15%** over the base orientation.

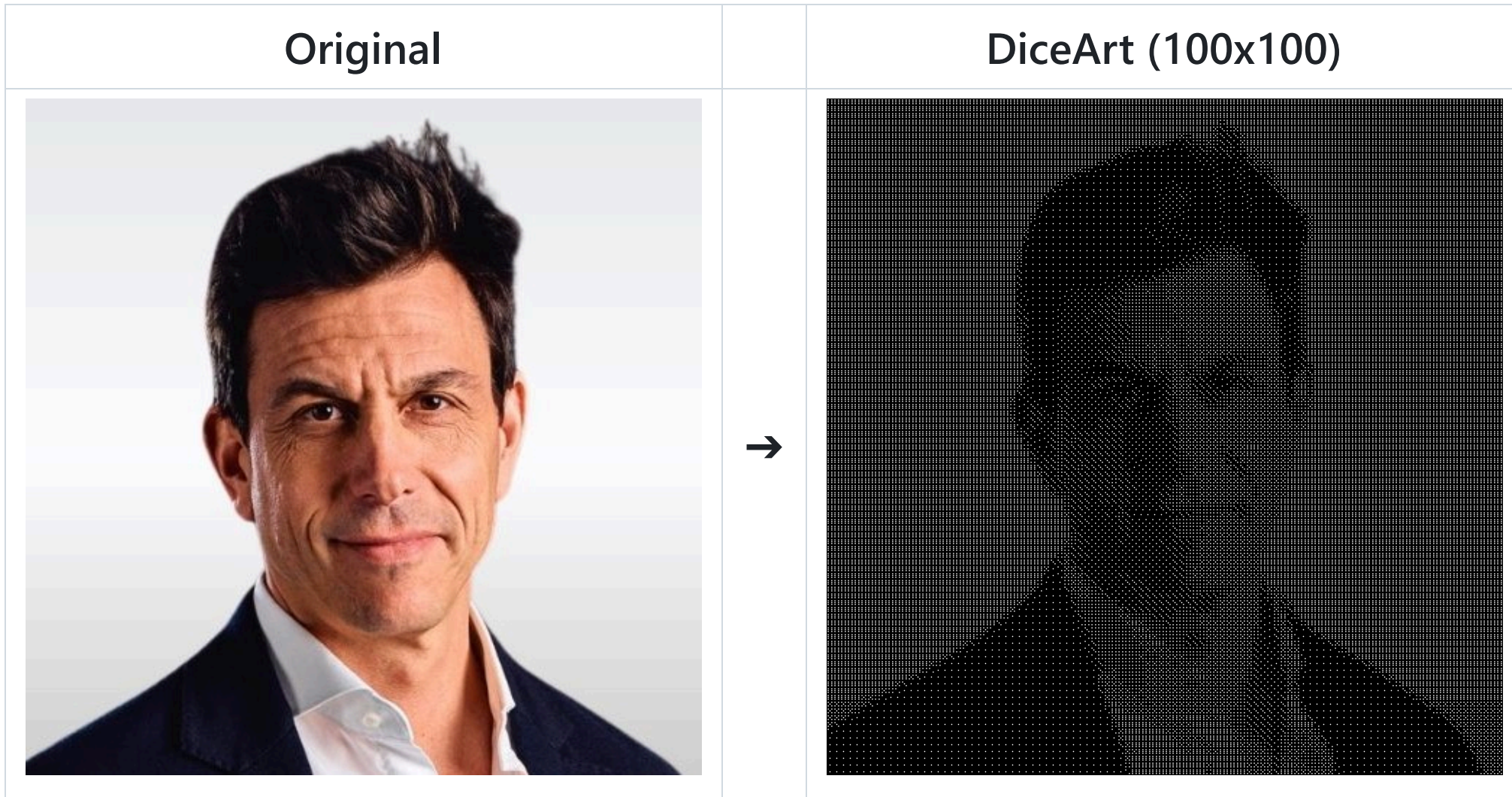
GUI



Demo: Christopher Waltz (Adaptive Algorithm)



Demo: Toto Wolff (Adaptive Algorithm)



Lessons Learned

- **Perceptual Computing:** What is mathematically "correct" or "optimal" isn't always what looks best to the human eye (hence the need for the Adaptive algorithm).
- **Asynchronous Design:** Using signals and slots to separate backend data processing from visual representation.

Thank You

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